

IN CONTEXT

Romanticism and revolution

A key idea of European Romanticism was the drawing together of different art forms into a single work—as in Liszt’s orchestral symphonic poems, with their portrayals of ideas and characters from, for example, literature (Tasso: *Lamento e trionfo* and *Hamlet*). Liszt was also deeply responsive to the radical political movements of his era. When the Hungarian nationalist revolution of 1849 was brutally put down by the ruling Hapsburg Empire, Liszt composed his tumultuous piano work *Funérailles* in memory of those who had died in the nationalist cause.



DEFEAT OF THE HUNGARIAN REBELS AT
VILAGOS, AUGUST 1849

Franz Liszt was born in 1811 in the eastern Austrian village of Raiding. His father, Adam Liszt, a manager on the local aristocratic Esterházy estate, was a cellist who had played in the Esterházy family’s private